Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Hold	$615.34 ▼ 1.47%	12M Price Target $680.00	52-Week Range $520.26 – $779.82	Market Cap $1.57T

META: Post-Earnings Hangover as AI Spending Spooks Street

WHAT HAPPENED

- META drifted down 1.5% on light volume (15M shares vs usual 30M+) — this isn't panic selling, it's just investors shrugging after a volatile week. The real story: traders are loading up on October puts at $617-$622 strikes at 8-20x normal volume. Somebody with real money is betting on near-term downside, probably hedging into year-end or positioning for a regulatory headline.
- Two insiders (COO Olivan and a director) dumped shares at $640 earlier this week. Not a mass exodus, but when the COO sells on strength, I pay attention — he knows the capex plans better than anyone.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: META is stuck in no-man's land at $615, sitting at just 37% of its 52-week range (meaning it's closer to the yearly low of $520 than the high of $780). The market is wrestling with a core question — Zuckerberg is spending $70B+ a year on AI infrastructure (data centers, Nvidia chips, custom silicon), and investors can't decide if that's visionary or reckless. The put flow tells me smart money thinks there's more pain coming before clarity arrives, likely tied to the FTC antitrust case that's heating up again and the EU's Digital Markets Act fines piling up. What to watch: if META can show ANY early AI monetization (think: AI-powered ad targeting lifting conversion rates), the stock re-rates higher fast — but if Q4 guidance implies another capex hike without revenue, we revisit $560. ===IMPLICATIONS===

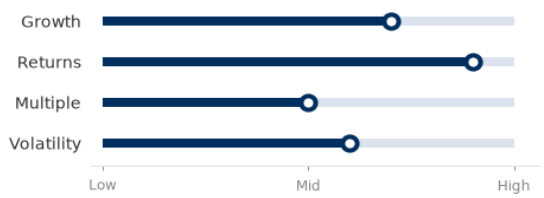
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two big policy threads right now: (1) The FTC's antitrust trial against Meta over Instagram/WhatsApp is in the remedy phase — a forced divestiture is still a tail risk and would be catastrophic short-term but potentially unlock value long-term (sum-of-parts is higher than current price). (2) The KOSA (Kids Online Safety Act) and various state-level social media age-verification laws are expanding — these raise compliance costs but ironically favor META over smaller competitors who can't afford the infrastructure. Also watch: the ongoing debate in Congress about Section 230 reform and the H-1B visa fee hikes, which hit Big Tech hiring directly and would raise META's engineering costs.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data	
Price (USD)	**$615.34**
12M Price Target	**$680.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+10.5%**
Market Cap	**$1.57T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$196M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$225M**
FY2026E EPS	**$25.80**
FY2027E EPS	**$29.40**
Fwd P/E	**23.8x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

META — Meta Platforms, Inc. | October 30, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$660.00**	$620.00	**$575.00**
6 Months	**$740.00**	$660.00	**$540.00**
1 Year	**$820.00**	$680.00	**$500.00**
2 Years	**$950.00**	$760.00	**$450.00**
5 Years	**$1300.00**	$900.00	**$400.00**
10 Years	**$2000.00**	$1200.00	**$350.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Defensive sectors — Consumer Staples (+1.79%), Utilities (+1.00%), Healthcare (+0.96%). This is a classic risk-off rotation, usually driven by either rate uncertainty or macro fear. Energy's up too (+1.37%) which hints at geopolitical tension creeping into oil.

COOLING OFF: Tech isn't on the leaderboard today, which tells you money is leaving growth and parking in safe cash-flow names. Materials is red, which suggests the market isn't betting on a strong industrial rebound.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic defensive rotation — money fleeing high-multiple growth (META included) into dividend-paying boring stuff. This usually happens when traders are nervous about either Fed policy or an earnings miss cycle. For META specifically, this means short-term pressure even if nothing fundamental changes.

RELATED PLAY: If you want AI exposure without META's regulatory baggage, look at the infrastructure layer — Nvidia (NVDA), the hyperscaler-exposed utilities (VST, CEG for nuclear/data center power), or data center REITs like EQIX.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GOOGL (Alphabet): Benefiting from a cleaner AI monetization story via Gemini + Cloud, and less regulatory heat than META right now
- NVDA (Nvidia): The pick-and-shovel winner — every dollar META spends on AI capex becomes NVDA revenue

META CONTEXT: META is lagging the mega-cap tech group this week, which tells me the market is specifically worried about META's capex-to-revenue conversion story, not AI broadly. That's a company-specific overhang, not a sector problem — which means if META can prove the ROI story, it catches up fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Cautiously constructive. The core ad business is a cash printer, but the regulatory and capex overhangs mean I'm not pounding the table at $615.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that an FTC headline doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add aggressively at $575-$595 (near-term support) and back up the truck below $540. At $615 it's a hold, not a buy.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is Q4 earnings in late January, specifically 2027 capex guidance and any AI revenue callouts.

WHEN TO BAIL: FTC breakup order, or 2027 capex guide above $130B without matching revenue growth, or Zuckerberg loses dual-class voting control (extremely unlikely but game-changing).

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option for Jan or March at the $580 strike. Think of it as insurance: you pay a small premium, and if META crashes on bad news, that put gains value and offsets your stock losses.

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